

Absolutely — since you explicitly asked to redo it, here is a much more complete version following the new SOP.

Word family: **promise / promised / promising**

Base word: promise

Past tense: promised

Past participle: promised

Related forms: promising, promise

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞) / adjective (相關形式)

Your sentence:

> “It was not flashy, aggressive, or full of empty **promises**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **promise** is a **noun**.

Meaning: A statement in which someone gives an assurance that they will do something, provide something, or that something will happen.

繁體中文: **向別人作出保證, 表示自己會做某事、提供某物, 或某件事將會發生的承諾**

中文翻譯:

「它並不花巧浮誇, 也不咄咄逼人, 更沒有充斥**空洞而缺乏實際兌現行動的承諾**。」

promise = 對未來行動或結果作出的保證／承諾

In **empty promises**, the word **empty** tells us those promises sound good but lack real intention or action.

1. **promise to + verb (承諾要做的行動) — 承諾／答應會做.....**

Here, **promise** is a verb.

Meaning: To give someone a firm assurance that you will do something.

Practice 1

> “She **promised to** call me after the meeting.”

「她**答應會**在會議後打電話給我。」

Practice 2

> “The company **promised to** fix the problem within two days.”

「公司**承諾會**在兩天內解決問題。」

Practice 3

> “He **promised to** return the money by Friday.”

「他**答應會**在星期五前還錢。」

****promise to + verb = 向別人保證自己之後會做某個行動****

2. ****promise + that-clause (承諾某件事情會發生／屬實) — 保證; 承諾.....****

****Meaning:**** To firmly assure someone that a statement is true or that a future event will happen.

Practice 4

> “I **promise that** I’ll be there on time.”

「我**保證**我會準時到。」

Practice 5

> “They **promised that** the service would improve.”

「他們**承諾**服務會有所改善。」

****promise that... = 對某項事實或未來結果作出明確保證****

3. ****promise + person + something (向某人承諾會給予的東西／結果) — 答應給某人.....; 承諾某人會得到.....****

****Meaning:**** To commit to giving or providing something to someone.

Practice 6

> “My manager **promised me** a day off.”

「我的經理**答應給我**一天假期。」

Practice 7

> “They **promised the customer** a full refund.”

「他們**承諾會給顧客**全額退款。」

promise someone something = 承諾某人將會獲得某物或某種結果

4. **promise = commitment/assurance (對未來行動或結果作出的保證) — 承諾; 諾言**

Here, **promise** is a noun.

Meaning: A firm statement that you will do something or that something will happen.

Practice 8 — Original

> “It was not flashy, aggressive, or full of empty **promises**.”

「它並不花巧浮誇, 也不咄咄逼人, 更沒有充斥**缺乏實際兌現行動的空洞承諾**。」

Practice 9

> “She made a **promise** to help him.”

「她作出了一個**承諾, 表示會幫助他**。」

Practice 10

> “He kept his **promise** and arrived on time.”

「他**履行了承諾**, 準時到達。」

promise = 對自己將會做的事情或某個未來結果作出的保證

Common collocations:

* **make a promise** = 作出承諾

* **keep a promise** = 履行承諾

* **break a promise** = 違背承諾

* **empty promise** = 空洞承諾

* **false promise** = 虛假承諾

5. **promise** = potential for future success (未來成功或變好的潛力) — 潛力; 前途

This is a genuinely different noun meaning.

Meaning: Signs that a person, idea, product, or project is likely to become successful or good in the future.

Practice 11

> “The young designer shows great **promise**.”

「這位年輕設計師展現出很大的**未來發展潛力**。」

Practice 12

> “The new technology has considerable **promise**.”

「這項新科技有相當大的**發展前景和成功潛力**。」

show promise = 顯示出未來很可能成功或發展良好的潛力

This is not 「承諾」.

6. **promising** = person/idea/product (人／構思／產品) likely to succeed or develop well — 很有前途的; 顯示出成功潛力的

Meaning: Showing signs that something is likely to be successful, useful, or good in the future.

Practice 13

> “She is a **promising** young engineer.”

「她是一位**很有前途、顯示出很大發展潛力的**年輕工程師。」

Practice 14

> “The early results are very **promising**.”

「初步結果**顯示未來很可能有良好成效**。」

****promising = 已經顯示出未來可能成功、改善或發展良好的跡象****

7. ****promise to be + adjective/noun (某事看來將會呈現某種結果) — 看來很可能會.....; 有望成為.....****

Here, the subject is often a situation, event, day, project, etc., rather than a person literally making a promise.

****Meaning:**** To appear likely to develop in a particular way.

Practice 15

> “The conference ****promises to be**** very interesting.”

「這次會議****看來很可能會非常有趣****。」

Practice 16

> “The new project ****promises to be**** a major success.”

「這個新專案****有望成為一項重大成功****。」

****promise to be = 從目前跡象看來, 很可能會發展成某種結果****

This is figurative. The conference is not literally making a promise.

8. ****promise = indication that something is likely to happen (預示未來可能出現某種結果) — 預示; 顯示有望.....****

This is closely related to #5 and #7, but here ****promise**** refers more generally to an indication or prospect of a future result.

Practice 17

> “The clear skies held the ****promise**** of a beautiful day.”

「晴朗的天空****預示著今天很可能會是美好的一天****。」

Practice 18

> “The discovery offers the ****promise**** of better treatment.”

「這項發現**帶來了未來可能出現更佳治療方法的希望／前景**。」

the promise of something = 顯示某種理想結果未來可能實現的前景

Important distinction: **promise vs guarantee**

They overlap, but **guarantee** is usually stronger.

promise

= a person or organization gives their word

= **作出承諾**

> “They promised to repair it.”

「他們承諾會修理。」

guarantee

= give a stronger assurance, sometimes formally or legally

= **保證／擔保**

> “The product is guaranteed for two years.”

「這件產品有兩年保養／保證。」

A **promise** can be broken.

A **guarantee** often implies stronger responsibility if the result fails.

Important distinction: **promise vs promising**

promise

Can mean a commitment:

> “He made a promise.”

「他作出了承諾。」

Or potential:

> “He shows promise.”

「他展現出潛力。」

promising

Means likely to succeed:

> “He is a promising student.”

「他是一名很有前途的學生。」

Important distinction: **empty promise**

An **empty promise** is not a different meaning of **promise** itself.

The core sense is still:

****promise = 對未來行動或結果作出的保證****

The adjective **empty** changes the quality of that promise:

> **empty promise**

> = **表面上作出保證，但實際缺乏兌現意圖、行動或實質內容的承諾**

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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promise to + verb	向別人保證自己之後會做某個行動
promise that...	對某項事實或未來結果作出明確保證
promise someone something	承諾某人將會得到某物或某種結果
a promise	對未來行動或結果作出的明確承諾／諾言
promise — potential	顯示未來可能成功或發展良好的潛力
promising	已顯示出未來可能成功或有良好發展的
promise to be...	從目前跡象看來，很可能發展成某種結果
the promise of...	預示某種理想結果未來可能實現的前景

For your original sentence

> “It was not flashy, aggressive, or full of empty ****promises****.”

The exact meaning is:

****promise = 對未來會做某事、提供某物或產生某個結果作出的保證****

And:

****empty promise = 表面上作出保證，但實際缺乏兌現意圖、實際行動或實質內容的承諾****